

show you how to sell near the top before the decline really begins. That way you can keep more of your profit or make even more by shorting.

Statistics

[Table 15.2](#) shows general statistics for BARR tops.

Number found. BARR tops are plentiful. I found the first one in July 1991 and finished my search in August 2019. During that time, I found 1,766 in 758 stocks.

Reversal (R), continuation (C) occurrence. Most of the patterns acted as reversals of the prevailing price trend, not as continuations. Because we know the breakout will be downward from a valid BARR top, the inbound price trend for a reversal must be below the pattern.

[Table 15.2](#) General Statistics

Description	Bull Market	Bear Market
Number found	1,488	278
Reversal (R), continuation (C) occurrence	76% R, 24% C	73% R, 27% C
Reversal, continuation performance	−17% R, −19% C	−24% R, −25% C
Average decline	−17%	−24%
Standard & Poor's 500 change	−1%	−12%
Days to ultimate low	67	54
How many change trend?	33%	57%

Reversal/continuation performance. There's not a big performance difference between reversals and continuations as the table shows.

Average decline. As you would expect, the average decline in bull markets (17%) is less than the superb results in bear markets (24%). Both are better than the average decline for all chart pattern types, which is why the pattern has a good performance rank.